

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Noble Essence of the Nectar Preparation, the Fourth'

Ārya-Kuṇḍalī-amṛta-hṛdaya-caturtha-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 755 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཀུན་དམ་འཛིན་པ་བོན་པོ་ཞེས་བརྒྱུད་པའི་གཟུངས།

Toh 755 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in English as "The Noble Essence of the Nectar Preparation, the Fourth," in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Kuṇḍalī-amṛta-hṛdaya-caturtha-nāma-dhāraṇī, and in Tibetan as ཀུན་དམ་འཛིན་པ་བོན་པོ་ཞེས་བརྒྱུད་པའི་གཟུངས། It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on the wrathful deity Amṛta-Kuṇḍalī, a powerful protector associated with Vajrapāṇi, who addresses the Buddha on behalf of beings in a degenerate age lacking merit and faith. The text presents sacred dhāraṇī formulas and teachings attributed to this wrathful figure, reflecting the tantric tradition of invoking fierce protective deities for the benefit of sentient beings. It was translated into Tibetan from Sanskrit by the Indian masters Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, and revised and finalized by the great Tibetan translator the monk Yeshe De.

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In the language of India: Ārya-Kuṇḍalī-amṛta-hṛdaya, caturtha-nāma-dhāraṇī.

In the Tibetan language: The dhāraṇī called "The Noble Essence of the Nectar Preparation, the Fourth."

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, the wrathful one.

Then the great wrathful one Amṛta-Kuṇḍalī, having gathered the entire assembly about him, gazed upon them all with the gaze of a great elephant, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, the sentient beings of this age are of little merit, do not abide in proper conduct, show no reverence to their fathers and mothers, have scant merit, are without faith, seek out opportunities for harm, are constantly consumed by greed for material things, are constantly led astray and are violent, and are seized upon by flesh-eaters. For the sake of destroying and utterly vanquishing those obstacles and misleading influences, I request that you teach the secret mantras."

Then the Blessed One spoke thus to the wrathful vajra-being: "Amṛta-Kuṇḍalī, it is excellent — truly excellent — that you have requested this for the benefit of all sentient beings. The Tathāgata grants you leave. Speak the secret mantras for the sake of all sentient beings."

Then the wrathful one Amṛta-Kuṇḍalī, touching his head to the feet of the Blessed One and of Vajrapāṇi, taught the secret mantras:

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaś caṇḍa-vajra-bāṇaye. Mahāyakṣa-senāpataye. Namo vajra-krodhāya. Prajvalita-dīpta-daṃṣṭrotkaṭa. Bhayabhairavāya. Asi-musala. Vajra-bhrūṃ-vāśa-hastāya. Tadyathā: Oṃ hulu hulu. Amṛta-kuṇḍalīni. Kha kha kha kha. Khana khana. Khāda khāda. Khāhi khāhi. Khāhi khāhi. Tiṣṭha tiṣṭha. Hana hana. Daha daha. Paca paca. Gṛhṇa gṛhṇi. Bandha bandha. Garjja garjja. Tarjja tarjja. Pisphota ya. Visphota ya. Bhagavan. Amṛta-kuṇḍa's mūrdhāntāṭaya vajreṇa. Sarva-vighna-nāyakānāṃ nipāraya. Mahāgaṇapati-jīvitānta-karāya hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ. Oṃ krodha-gaṇapataye svāhā.

This is the first mantra of the Nectar Preparation.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaś caṇḍa-vajra-pāṇaye. Mahāyakṣa-senāpataye. Namo mahāvajra-krodhāya. Daṃṣṭrotkaṭa. Bhairavāya. Asi-brṣṭa-na-hastāya. He he. Pata pata. Dhava dhava. Kha kha. Khāhi khāhi. Amṛta-kuṇḍali. Tiṣṭha tiṣṭha. Bandha bandha. Hana hana. Garjja garjja. Gaṇapati-jīvitānta-karāya svāhā.

This is the second mantra.

Namo ratnatrayāya. Namaś caṇḍa-vajra-bāṇayo. Mahāyakṣa-senāpataye. Namo vajra-krodhāya. Vimala-kanaka-jvala-bhūṣaṇāya. Gagana-amṛta-sambhavāya. Rakta-mālyā. Anulepana-priyāya. Vajrapāṇi-priyāya. Vajrapāṇi-priyāya. Vajrapāṇi-tulya. Vegāya. Deva. Nāga. Yakṣa. Rākṣasa. Pramathānāla. Trailokya-gocaradāya. Śata-sainya-dravana-karāya. Triratna-garbhoṭṭamāya. Amṛta-kuṇḍa-yī. Ehyehi daṃṣṭrotkaṭa. Bhairavābhāya gagana-pidya-da-jvala-sphuliṅgāśani. Tulyarubodhi-taṃ-sambhuta. Oṃ kha kha kha kha. Gṛhṇā gṛhṇa. Bandha bandha. Hana hana. Garjja garjja. Visphota ya. Dhaka dhaka. Jvala jvala. Prajvāla prajvala. Grasa grasa. Sarva-vighnanānāṃ nāyakānāṃ. Hṛdayaṃ phaṭ. Gandharva-hṛdayaṃ phaṭ. Rakṣa-hṛdayaṃ phaṭ. Brahma-rākṣasa-hṛdayaṃ phaṭ. Sarva-jvara-hṛdayaṃ phaṭ. Sarva-cāturthaka-hṛdayaṃ phaṭ. Sarva-nāgānāṃ hṛdayaṃ phaṭ. Hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Daha daha. Paca paca. Āpiśa āpiśa. Iḍaṃ me ekāryaṃ kuru

vajradhara-ājñāpayati svāhā.

This is the third mantra.

Namo vajra-krodhāya. Daṃṣṭotkaṭa. Vairavāya. Tadyathā: Hulu hulu. Kha kha. Khāhi khāhi. Tiṣṭha tiṣṭha. Bandha bandha svāhā.

This is the fourth secret mantra of the wrathful vajra, the Elixir Conjunction.

Next, having extracted the meaningful essences of these mantras, and having recited and accomplished them, I shall now explain what it means to have recited all my secret mantras well and to have accomplished them.

This, then, is my heart-essence: Oṃ amṛte hūṃ phaṭ. This is the heart-essence of the Elixir Conjunction.

The moment the Vajra Wrathful One of the Elixir Conjunction had finished expounding these secret mantras, this great earth trembled in six ways. The misleading spirits (those who lead beings astray) were also seized with terror, and, finding themselves without refuge and without support, they went before the Tathāgata and spoke these words: "Blessed One, please be our refuge! Sugata, please be our refuge!" — and with that they prostrated, lowering their heads to the ground.

Then came this proclamation: "Listen well, you unruly misleading spirits — hear my words! Blazing and fiercely blazing with vajra-fire, blazing and supremely blazing everywhere, your very scalp shall crack. Remember how, through the secret mantras of those of the golden-matted locks, I have, for the span of a thousand divine years, struck down, split apart, beaten, pierced, and withered the misleading spirits. Remember my power, my diligence, and my great supremacy over adversaries!

"Do not seek an opening against one who holds, recites, accomplishes, and guards these secret mantras — whether they eat sesame and oil-cakes, or eat inferior food, or whether they are engaged in ordinary village observances. Do not seek an opening against those accomplishing all the vidyā-mantras. Even when one eats a meal, the first mouthful should be consecrated with the mantra and offered. If one recites this seven times at sunrise, from that day forward the mantra will always follow close behind, and the misleading spirits will find no opening.

"Even if one has consumed sesame, small legumes, rice, or cumin, or has carried oil, or has gone to a charnel ground — even having eaten all of these, if one holds my secret mantras, all of it shall be accomplished. Know,

furthermore, that the qualities are immeasurable."

The noble Elixir —

Translator's Notes

- The mantras are transliterated from Tibetan-script Sanskrit and contain the expected orthographic irregularities of that transmission medium. The rendering here follows the syllables as written without normalization, since dhāraṇī and mantra texts are transmitted as sacred sound-units and editorial emendation would be inappropriate. A trained Sanskrit philologist would note several phonetic corruptions typical of Tibetan manuscript transmission, but these are not corrected in a liturgical context.

The term rendered "flesh-eaters" translates Tibetan "sha za," referring to a class of malevolent spirits who consume flesh — closely related to the Sanskrit piśāca class — distinct from ordinary carnivorous beings.

The phrase translated "gaze of a great elephant" is a standard Indian literary simile for a slow, commanding, all-encompassing survey of one's surroundings, connoting both power and benign authority.

- The text breaks off mid-phrase at the end with "The noble Elixir" corresponding to the opening of what appears to be a title or colophon beginning with "Ārya Amṛta..." which is cut off in the supplied passage; the translation preserves this exactly as given.

The phrase rendered "those of the golden-matted locks" refers to wrathful deities or vidyādhara figures characterized by yellow or golden matted hair, a conventional iconographic description in this genre of dhāraṇī and mantra literature.

"Carrying oil" and "going to a charnel ground" are among the usual ritual impurities that in many Vinaya and mantra contexts would disqualify a practitioner from recitation; the passage reassures that holding the mantra overcomes even such defilements.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.